

was possible to be a Mazdean without ever having heard of Zarathushtra, we have nothing left as proof, and next to nothing amounting to a presumption, that Cyrus had come in contact with the Reform. His creed was more probably the popular Iranian nature-worship described so accurately by Herodotus in the *locus classicus* we shall be taking up presently. In many particulars its elemental worship would agree sufficiently with Babylonian and Elamite; and "the God of heaven" in the Ezra rescript suits his own religious phraseology perfectly, especially if his chief god was *Diyauš*, the sky.¹ Since he and his ancestors ruled in a country which was not Iranian, we naturally expect to find non-Aryan traits in any account of him and his ideas.

One solitary scrap of evidence in favour of Cyrus's connexion with Zoroastrianism I am bound to present before I leave him, and I believe the point—*valeat quantum!*—is new. He called his daughter Atossa, which is identified with the Avestan *Hutaosâ*. This was the name of Vishtaspa's queen; and of course the name of Vishtaspa himself, Zarathushtra's royal patron, was perpetuated in the Achæmenian family, in Hystaspes the father of Darius. I do not think the double coincidence can be accidental. How much does it prove? We will return to this when we come to Darius, from whom we are detained for a moment by the intervention of Cambyses. It seems almost grotesque to discuss the religion of one whom only the accident of birth and time rescued from segregation as a criminal lunatic. But maniac though he was, we should expect him to be restrained by

¹ On this see below, pp. 60 i 391 f.